Activity 3 — Role-Play Observer Checklist

Diagnosing Customer Needs at a Growing SME — TechNova Account Review

Focus of this observation	Needs discovery — open questioning, active listening and the four levels
You are observing	Role A — the TechNova Account Manager
Setup	Pairs. Role A = TechNova Account Manager, Role B = Daniel Lim. Observer optional.
Duration	25 minutes

Observer: _____ Performer: _____ Round: 1 / 2

Tick DONE only where you actually saw the behaviour. 'What good looks like' is the standard — anything less is NOT YET.

#	What to observe	What good looks like	Done	Not yet
1	**Opened by acknowledging the relationship**	Referenced the six-year history before raising any problem or product.		
2	**Asked open questions first**	Used what / how / tell me / walk me through. Closed questions only to confirm specifics.		
3	**Paraphrased each answer before moving on**	Said the answer back in their own words and waited for confirmation.		
4	**Surfaced the REAL brief**	Got to the MD deadline at month end — not just the three stated complaints.		
5	**Identified an emotional need, not only functional ones**	Recognised that Daniel is exposed in front of his MD, not merely inconvenienced by slow uploads.		
6	**Did NOT propose an upgrade in the first 4 minutes**	Diagnosed before prescribing; no early sales pitch.		
7	**Raised the 15-seat breach as a discovery, not an accusation**	Framed it as 'your growth outran the plan we sold you' rather than a contract violation.		
8	**Proposed an action at each of the four levels**	Understand → meet the basic need → outside the box → extra mile (the MD's report).		

Strongest moment — what worked, and why

One thing to change in the next round

The performer's own view (ask them first, before you give feedback)

Check your work: Your needs analysis has at least one emotional need identified, all four levels populated, and your role-play partner confirms you surfaced the MD deadline as the real brief.

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